NORWAY UNPACKED

Product Requirements Document

A personal, source-verified English knowledge base for understanding Norway.

> **Core positioning**
> Understand Norway. The country, the culture and how things actually work - explained by Andreas, with facts anchored in primary and trusted sources.

Domain	norwayunpacked.com
Version	1.1
Date	11 August 2026
Owner / development	Swane Creative
Public author	Andreas
Public contact	kontakt@swanecreative.no

STATUS: READY FOR PHASE 0 / BUILD FOUNDATION

This PRD defines the product, editorial system, source-verification model, information architecture, design direction, technical guardrails, monetization principles, analytics, launch content, image-placeholder workflow and implementation gates. Version 1.1 incorporates the final pre-build decisions on contact identity, preliminary brand/domain checks and asset placeholders.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Decisions locked in v1.1

Decision	v1.1 requirement
Domain	norwayunpacked.com; apex is canonical.
Language	English only at launch.
Public author identity	Andreas. Do not display full name as the byline.
Ownership / development	Swane Creative may be credited in the footer and About page.
Public contact	kontakt@swanecreative.no on Contact and relevant policy / correction surfaces.
Positioning	A knowledge base / editorial reference about Norway, not primarily a travel blog.
Tone	Personal first-person context where authentic; factual claims remain source-grounded.
Design	Editorial Scandinavian; no generic Tailwind/SaaS visual language.
Images	Placeholder-first workflow. Claude may not improvise or silently replace unapproved assets.
Monetization	No display ads at launch. Commercial links only where user intent makes them useful.
AI use	AI may assist research, drafting, structure and QA, but may never invent Andreas experiences or unverifiable facts.
Launch breadth	Target content set: 24 high-quality articles, built in controlled waves - never mass-generated in one sprint.

Pre-build checks completed since v1.0

- Preliminary name / trademark searches found no obvious Norway Unpacked conflict. This is a practical pre-build check, not formal legal clearance.
- No prior public website history was found for norwayunpacked.com in the checks performed before build planning.
- Public contact address is locked: kontakt@swanecreative.no.
- Image placeholders and per-slot briefs are now mandatory; see Section 14 and Appendix F.

Remaining pre-build / pre-launch checks

- Final logo / favicon / icon refinement and preferred social handles.
- Select and license actual editorial photography; prioritize Andreas-owned photography when suitable.
- GA4, Search Console, Bing Webmaster Tools and consent configuration when the first production deployment exists.
- Affiliate partner research only when transactional travel pages are ready.

> **PRD status**
>
> The strategic PRD is complete. Remaining items are execution checks, asset procurement and platform setup. Do not reopen product scope unless new evidence materially changes the direction.

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A site for understanding Norway, not just visiting it

Norway Unpacked is an English-language knowledge base for foreigners who want to understand Norway. It combines source-verified explanations of Norwegian systems and institutions with a first-person Norwegian perspective from Andreas. The product covers society, everyday life, culture, history, nature, travel, food and sport in one connected information architecture.

The central opportunity is not to become another “complete Norway guide”. Existing competitors prove demand for English-language Norway content, but the strongest opportunity is the combination of three things: authoritative explanations, personal local context and a calm modern product experience. Norway Unpacked should feel closer to a high-quality digital magazine and reference work than to an SEO blog.

> **The product promise**
> I explain Norway from the inside - and show you where the facts come from.

Three engines

Engine	Role	Examples
Authority engine	Build trust, links and citation value.	Oil Fund, welfare state, healthcare, education, politics, history.
Personality engine	Make the brand distinct and memorable.	Dugnad, hytte, matpakke, Janteloven, friluftsliv, 17 May.
Revenue engine	Monetize only where the visitor already has commercial intent.	Hotels, activities, transport, itineraries, selected travel products.

What success looks like

- Users get a clear answer quickly, then understand the context and can verify important facts at the source.
- Articles are useful enough to be linked, cited, revisited and surfaced in Google and AI search.
- Personal observations make the site human without weakening factual rigor.
- The site grows from a small number of excellent templates and articles, not mass-produced long-tail pages.
- Commercial content funds the project without contaminating neutral knowledge content.

Positioning and reason to exist

One-sentence product definition

> **Definition**
> Norway Unpacked is a personal, source-verified English guide to the country, the culture and how Norway actually works.

Homepage messaging direction

Primary brand: Norway Unpacked

Primary promise: Understand Norway.

Supporting line: The country, the culture and how things actually work.

Alternative short copy may be tested during design, but the meaning must remain the same: clear explanations, local context and documented facts.

Why users should choose it

Need	Norway Unpacked response
“I just want the answer.”	Short answer immediately under the article introduction or H1 area.
“Why is Norway like this?”	Context, history and related concepts - not just definitions.
“Can I trust this?”	Visible primary sources, fact-check date and careful freshness handling.
“What does this feel like in real life?”	Authentic first-person observations from Andreas.
“What should I read next?”	Curated related topics and knowledge-graph connections.
“I am planning a trip.”	Useful travel content with transparent, relevant commercial options later.

Editorial north star

Norway Unpacked should explain Norway the way a knowledgeable Norwegian friend would explain it - but with the sourcing discipline of a reference site.

Who the site is for and what they are trying to do

Audience	Typical situation	Primary jobs to be done
Curious foreigners	Interested in Norway from abroad.	Understand society, wealth, culture, Vikings, history, politics and everyday customs.
Tourists	Planning or taking a trip.	Understand seasons, transport, places, costs, etiquette, outdoors and booking choices.
People considering life in Norway	Work, study, family move or temporary stay.	Understand healthcare, schools, NAV, taxes, housing, practical systems and social norms.
Question-led searchers	Arrive from Google, Bing or an AI answer.	Get one precise answer, verify it, then discover related concepts.
Writers / researchers / media	Need a clear English explanation.	Find concise, source-backed context and primary-source links.

Primary usage pattern

1. Land on a specific article or homepage search.
2. Get a short, direct answer without wading through a biography, advert or long preamble.
3. Read context and Andreas perspective if useful.
4. Open official sources for important facts or decisions.
5. Follow one or more related topics to understand how the subject connects to Norway more broadly.

Language

Use international English. Avoid unnecessary Americanisms or Britishisms when a neutral formulation works. Norwegian words should be retained when they are part of the concept - e.g. dugnad, friluftsliv, fastlege, kommune - with a plain-English explanation on first use.

What the discovery work says

Ubersuggest exports supplied for the project show a clear hierarchy among the direct English-language Norway competitors. The figures below are third-party estimates and should be treated as directional rather than first-party traffic data.

Domain / data set	Directional signal	What matters for Norway Unpacked
lifeinnorway.net - US/UK	~103.3K organic traffic, ~48.9K organic keywords, DA 61, ~131.2K backlinks.	The true authority competitor. Broad Norway content can build large search visibility and link authority.
norwaywithpal.com - US	~4.4K organic traffic, ~3.5K keywords, DA 20, ~1.5K backlinks.	Personal local voice can perform; specific food/culture/local-guide content works.
norwayexplained.com - US	~189 organic traffic, ~2.4K keywords, DA 13, ~98 backlinks.	Large article breadth alone is not enough. Many generic travel pages show minimal estimated traffic.

Themes with clear evidence

- "How Norway works" has real demand: Nordic model, Norwegian Continental Shelf, jobs, cost of living, public systems and social rules all appear in competitor visibility.
- Culture and "things Norwegians take for granted" are strong: pølse, matpakke, nisse, Janteloven, traditions and local-perspective articles perform disproportionately well relative to domain size.
- Norse/Viking content has very large US search opportunity, but should remain a controlled History sub-cluster so it does not redefine the brand.
- Generic destination-guide mass production is a poor launch strategy. It is competitive, expensive to maintain and easy to make indistinguishable from existing travel sites.
- Authority pages can have value beyond direct estimated traffic: competitor history, healthcare, education and Nordic-model pages carry large backlink counts.

> **Strategic conclusion**
> Build Norway Unpacked around "understanding Norway". Travel and Vikings are important sections, not the identity of the site.

Rules that should survive individual sprints

Principle	Requirement
Answer first	Important pages give the user a useful answer near the top.
Context over keyword stuffing	Explain the topic and natural follow-up questions rather than create thin keyword variants.
Sources are a product feature	Facts, official rules and changing numbers are traceable to trusted sources.
Personal, not fictional	First-person voice is encouraged; invented personal memories are prohibited.
Calm web	No aggressive popups, vignette ads, sticky overlays or advertising that competes with the answer.
Editorial hierarchy	Typography, photography and whitespace create structure; not every idea becomes a card.
Selective commercial intent	Monetize the pages where booking or purchasing is part of the user task.
Build in verified waves	No uncontrolled content scaling before the article model, source workflow and indexing rules are proven.

Explicit non-goals for MVP

- No Norwegian-language version.
- No AI chatbot.
- No comments or community forum.
- No user accounts.
- No native app.
- No daily news operation or political breaking-news coverage.
- No automated AI publishing pipeline.
- No display advertising.
- No complex CMS unless repository-based content proves insufficient.
- No hundreds of destination pages.
- No large Norse mythology network at launch.
- No animation framework or component marketplace as a design dependency.

Andreas is the narrator; sources are the authority

Public authorship

Article byline: “By Andreas”. The site may explain on the About page that Norway Unpacked is developed by Swane Creative. Do not add a full surname to ordinary article bylines unless Andreas later changes this decision.

First-person rule

> **Hard rule**
> Claude and any other AI system must never invent Andreas’ memories, family stories, travel experiences, opinions or personal habits. If a first-person anecdote has not been supplied or confirmed, write neutral copy or flag a placeholder for Andreas.

Four statement types

Type	Example	Treatment
A. Documented fact	“The Storting has 169 representatives.”	Use trusted source when relevant; keep metadata and body consistent.
B. Rule / right / current procedure	“Who is entitled to a fastlege?”	Primary source required; freshness class F2/F3; clear caveats.
C. Explanation / interpretation	“A kommune is the local level of government most people interact with.”	Ground factual parts; explanation can be Norway Unpacked’s own pedagogy.
D. Personal / cultural observation	“I never thought taking shoes off indoors was unusual.”	Clearly framed as Andreas’ perspective, not a universal rule.

Voice characteristics

- Clear, conversational and intelligent; never tourist-brochure language.
- Warm but not promotional about Norway. The site may explain trade-offs, weaknesses and contradictions honestly.
- No generic “Norway is a land of breathtaking fjords and rich culture” filler.
- Use Norwegian terminology when it teaches the reader something.
- Use “I” when it adds native context; otherwise let the explanation lead.
- Avoid fake certainty. If sources disagree or rules are conditional, say so.

A verification system, not just a list of links

Source hierarchy

1. Primary official sources: government, ministries, directorates, public agencies, official institutions and source organisations.
2. Primary data and research: official statistics, original datasets, peer-reviewed research and universities.
3. High-quality reference sources: SNL and comparable reputable reference works when primary sources are impractical or for historical context.
4. Established journalism: for events, context or reporting that cannot be sourced directly.
5. Specialist sources: only when clearly qualified and materially useful.
6. Other blogs / competitors: discovery only by default; not a substitute for an available primary source.

Freshness classes

Class	Typical content	Review expectation	Display requirement
F0 - historical/stable	1814, Viking Age, historical definitions.	Event-driven or 24-36 months.	Update date optional unless materially revised.
F1 - stable systems/culture	How Storting works, long-lived institutions, cultural explanations.	At least annually or on known change.	Last updated when relevant.
F2 - change-prone rules	Rights, eligibility, transport rules, current officials, alcohol rules.	Typically every 3-6 months or on known change.	Visible fact-check date and official source.
F3 - current numbers/status	Oil Fund value, current rates, prices, population, current thresholds.	Before publication and at a topic-appropriate short interval.	Explicit “as of” date; do not present stale number as current.

Source registry data model

Field	Purpose
id	Stable internal source identifier.
name	Human-readable source title.
organisation	Institution responsible for the source.
url	Canonical external URL.
sourceType	official / data / research / reference / journalism / specialist.
checkedAt	Date the source was last opened and verified.
notes	Scope, caveats, language or known limitations.

supportsClaims	Optional IDs for high-risk claims.

Claim verification

Do not build a sentence-by-sentence bureaucracy for every cultural article. Instead, require a structured critical-claim registry for F2/F3 content and high-risk financial, health, legal or administrative explanations. Each critical claim can store an ID, the claim summary, source IDs, verification date and notes.

Source block on the public page

> **Sources & fact check**
> Show the most important sources, the last fact-check date and an honest note distinguishing official information from Andreas' personal observations. For important decisions, encourage the reader to follow the official source.

Eight editorial worlds connected by a knowledge graph

World	Scope
How Norway Works	Politics, government, welfare, NAV, healthcare, education, taxes, economy, oil, Oil Fund, EU/EEA.
Life in Norway	Work, housing, family, practical systems, shopping, transport, everyday life.
Culture & Traditions	Dugnad, friluftsliv, hytte, 17 May, Easter, Christmas, russ, Janteloven, social customs.
History & Vikings	Ancient Norway, Viking Age, Christianity, unions, 1814, 1905, WWII, postwar era, oil age.
Travel & Places	Cities, regions, itineraries, transport, accommodation, activities and first-visit guidance.
Nature & Outdoors	Fjords, mountains, wildlife, weather, northern lights, right to roam, hiking, skiing.
Food	Brunost, waffles, pølse, matpakke, traditional dishes, alcohol, coffee and modern food habits.
Sport	Skiing, football, handball, biathlon, cycling, major athletes and sports culture.

Knowledge-graph requirement

Every article should have intentionally curated related-topic relationships. “Related posts” based only on category or recency are not sufficient. Relationships should help a reader understand Norway as a system.

Starting article	Curated connections
Norway’s Oil Fund	Oil & gas → Norwegian Continental Shelf → welfare state → government budget → fiscal rule → taxes → Norwegian economy.
17 May	1814 → Constitution → Eidsvoll → royal family → bunad → russ → Norwegian flag → national identity.
Dugnad	Housing associations → sports clubs → volunteer culture → Janteloven → community life.
Friluftsliv	Right to roam → cabin culture → Easter → hiking → skiing → national parks.

Taxonomy guardrail

Do not create a new category for every editorial idea. Categories are stable high-level worlds; tags and related-topic edges carry the detailed relationships.

Simple URLs with explicit editorial meaning

Route	Purpose / indexation
/	Homepage; indexable.
/how-norway-works	Hub; indexable.
/life-in-norway	Hub; indexable.
/culture	Hub; indexable.
/history	Hub; indexable.
/travel	Hub; indexable.
/nature	Hub; indexable.
/food	Hub; indexable.
/sport	Hub; indexable.
/[world]/[slug]	Primary article pattern; indexable when published and source/quality checks pass.
/search	Site search. Indexation policy to be decided; default noindex if result combinations create low-value URLs.
/about	About Andreas and project.
/sources	How sources and verification work; public trust page.
/editorial-policy	Authorship, AI use, corrections and commercial independence.
/contact	Contact route.
/privacy	Privacy policy.
/disclaimer	Appropriate factual / commercial disclaimers.
/go/[slug]	Future affiliate redirect; noindex, not in sitemap, sponsored/nofollow at source link.

Canonical policy

- Primary domain: https://norwayunpacked.com.
- www should redirect to apex.
- Canonical, sitemap, Open Graph URLs and structured data must use the apex origin.
- No indexable duplicate query-parameter versions of editorial pages.
- Build/development should remain non-indexable until release gate is explicitly opened.

A knowledge-magazine homepage, not a blog feed

Required information hierarchy

1. Header / wordmark with calm navigation across the main worlds.
2. Hero with “Norway, unpacked.” / “Understand Norway.” positioning, one supporting paragraph and prominent search.
3. Popular searches or editorial shortcuts such as Oil Fund, Janteloven, tipping, NAV and visiting in winter.
4. Primary topic navigation for the eight worlds.
5. Signature module: “Things Norwegians rarely think about”.
6. Authority module: “Deep dives: How Norway works”.
7. Compact Andreas introduction with authentic portrait once supplied/approved.
8. Optional newsletter module only when a real newsletter workflow exists.
9. Quiet footer with About, Sources, Editorial Policy, Contact, Privacy and Swane Creative credit.

Homepage content rules

- Do not lead with “Recent posts”. Recency is not the main user need.
- Do not allow Travel to visually dominate the site identity.
- Do not show empty categories. The homepage may adapt during early launch until each world has sufficient content.
- No large pop-up, push-notification prompt or advertisement above the answer.
- Search must remain usable and prominent on mobile.

> **Homepage north star**
> A user should understand in five seconds that this is a place to understand Norway, not merely book a holiday.

One editorial system, multiple article shapes

Shared article primitives

Primitive	Purpose
ArticleHeader	Category, H1, dek, author, update/fact-check information.
ShortAnswer	40-80 word self-contained answer where the query benefits from one.
AndreasNote	Personal/local context; never auto-invented.
FactBox	Concise fact set with date / unit / source where relevant.
Definition	Plain-English explanation of a Norwegian concept.
Timeline	History and sequence-heavy topics.
SourceBlock	Visible sources and verification details.
RelatedTopics	Curated knowledge-graph links.
CommercialDisclosure	Only on commercially relevant pages.
Callout / caution	Conditional rules, exceptions, safety and high-risk caveats.

Core explainer template

1. Breadcrumb / category context.
2. H1 and concise dek.
3. By Andreas + updated / fact-checked status.
4. Hero image when useful.
5. The short version.
6. Personal contextual introduction if authentic and useful.
7. Core explanation sections.
8. Common misunderstanding / practical implication.
9. Related Norwegian terms or concepts.
10. Sources & fact check.
11. Keep exploring.

Templates must remain flexible

A recipe, city guide, political-system explainer and history timeline should not be forced into the exact same section sequence. Reuse the primitives, not a rigid article skeleton.

Front matter / content fields

Field group	Minimum fields
Identity	slug, title, dek, category, subcategory, aliases.
SEO	seoTitle, metaDescription, canonical override only when genuinely needed.
Authorship	author=Andreas, datePublished, dateModified.
Verification	freshnessClass, factCheckedAt, sourceIds, reviewStatus.
Relationships	relatedTopics, tags, searchSynonyms.
Commercial	commercialIntent = none/editorial/transactional; disclosure config where relevant.
Media	hero image reference, alt text, credit / license metadata.
Publishing	draft/review/published, featured flags, indexable gate.

Search Norway before adding AI chat

MVP behavior

Use a build-generated search index over titles, aliases, dek/excerpt, categories, Norwegian terms and selected topic keywords. Search must work without an external AI or live data service.

User query	Expected understanding
oil fund / oljefondet / sovereign wealth fund	Same core Oil Fund topic.
GP / fastlege	Healthcare / fastlege content.
kindergarten / barnehage	Norwegian kindergarten / education content.
municipality / kommune	Local government / kommune content.
17 may / constitution day	17 May content.

No-result handling

- Show a helpful no-results state with category links and suggested popular topics.
- If no-result queries are logged, apply consent rules and PII/safety filtering. Free-text search can contain personal data.
- Use no-result data to improve aliases and identify genuine content gaps.
- Do not generate a fabricated answer when the site has no verified content.

AI search later

If conversational search is introduced later, it should be retrieval-grounded on Norway Unpacked's verified corpus and preserve source links. The system must be allowed to say that the site does not have enough verified information.

Editorial Scandinavian - explicitly not generic Tailwind

Visual direction

The product should feel like a modern digital reference magazine: calm, legible, photographic and editorial. The latest approved concept mockup is the primary visual reference for hierarchy and mood, but Claude must not reproduce it mechanically or drift into a component-library aesthetic.

Token / pattern	Direction
Background	Warm white / cream rather than sterile pure white everywhere.
Ink	Very dark navy / near-black.
Accent	Muted Norwegian red-orange used sparingly for signals and links.
Secondary surface	Soft sand / blue-gray for editorial modules and fact areas.
Display type	Editorial serif direction such as Source Serif 4 or comparable; validate in browser.
Body / UI type	Neutral highly readable sans such as Source Sans 3 or comparable.
Radius	Small (roughly 6-10 px) where needed; no large pill-card aesthetic.
Shadows	Minimal. Hierarchy should come from spacing, type, lines and photography.
Reading width	Approx. 680-760 px for long text; media and data elements may break wider.
Page width	Approx. 1180-1240 px desktop content container.

Hard design prohibitions

- No pill buttons as the default control language.
- No glassmorphism.
- No decorative gradients by default.
- No three identical icon-in-circle feature cards merely because content is divisible by three.
- No icon on every heading.
- No badge soup.
- No 16-24 px border radius across the whole interface.
- No card shadow on every surface.
- No “Recent posts” sidebar.
- No hero overlay that makes the primary text hard to read.
- No full-screen ad or newsletter interruption.

- No 21st.dev / UI-kit component merely because it exists.

Responsive behavior

- Mobile first for reading and search. Header collapses to a simple menu without hiding search.
- At 320 px: no horizontal scrolling, no clipped navigation, no off-screen card content.
- Category modules may become stacked editorial rows rather than tiny multi-column cards.
- Article text remains comfortably readable; source links wrap cleanly; tables receive mobile alternatives when necessary.

Show real Norway, not only postcard Norway

Editorial image strategy

- Use spectacular nature when the topic genuinely calls for it.
- Also show ordinary Norway: public transport, homes, supermarkets, schoolyards, ferries, cabins, matpakke, streets, weather and everyday social life.
- Prefer original Andreas-owned photography when available and appropriate; maintain rights / credit metadata.
- For third-party photography, document license, source and credit requirements before publication.
- Do not hotlink editorial images. Store approved assets locally or through a controlled image pipeline.
- Use descriptive alt text; decorative imagery may use empty alt where appropriate.

Placeholder-first workflow

- Every planned image slot receives a stable placeholder ID and a written brief before the real asset exists.
- Reserve the final aspect ratio and approximate crop from day one so real images do not create layout shift.
- Each placeholder records subject, mood, orientation, factual risks, what to avoid, alt-text intent and expected source / rights status.
- **Claude must never silently replace a placeholder with arbitrary stock, remote or AI-generated imagery.** It may propose an asset or source, but the asset remains unapproved until explicitly accepted.
- Homepage and article placeholder briefs are defined in Appendix F.

Performance

Serve responsive AVIF/WebP where supported, reserve image dimensions, use appropriate loading priority for the LCP image and lazy-load below-the-fold editorial media.

AI-generated imagery

AI-generated images may be used selectively for illustrative concepts, but should not impersonate documentary photography or be presented as an authentic historical/place photograph. If an image could reasonably be misunderstood as real documentation, label it clearly or use a real/licensed image instead.

Be findable, understandable, citable and worth choosing

SEO and AI-search visibility are treated as one content-quality problem: the page must provide a clear answer, explicit context, consistent entities, visible sources and crawlable HTML. Do not create content “for a robot”; make the most useful verifiable page and structure it so machines do not have to guess.

Per-page requirements

- Unique SEO title, meta description, H1 and canonical.
- Primary meaning early in title and visible content.
- Direct answer of roughly 40-80 words when the search intent benefits from one; clarity overrides rigid length targets.
- Descriptive H2/H3 headings that answer natural follow-up questions.
- Visible source and update information where freshness matters.
- Internal links with descriptive anchor text to related concepts.
- Indexable server-rendered HTML for the main answer and article content.
- Open Graph metadata and share image.
- No thin pages for plural/singular or minor keyword permutations.

Metadata working ranges

Element	Working range	Notes
SEO title	45-60 chars; practical max ~65	Do not shorten at the cost of meaning.
Meta description	135-160; practical max ~165	One or two natural sentences.
H1	25-70; practical max ~80	One clear page topic.
Direct answer	40-80 words; practical max ~120	Self-contained and quotable.
H2	Preferably <70 chars	Use explanatory wording.
Body paragraph	Typically 40-100 words	One clear point per paragraph.

Indexation discipline

- Only published, quality-checked article routes enter the sitemap.
- Drafts, previews, admin/debug surfaces and affiliate redirect routes are noindex and excluded from sitemap.
- Use an environment-level indexability gate until production is ready for search engines.
- Validate canonical and sitemap against the apex domain before release.

Schema must match what the user sees

Schema	Use
Organization	Norway Unpacked / Swane Creative ownership relationship where accurate.
WebSite	Site identity and search capability where supported.
WebPage	General hubs and editorial pages.
Article	Published editorial articles with author and dates.
BreadcrumbList	Hierarchy from world → article.
Person	Andreas only where it accurately describes visible authorship.
FAQPage	Only when actual visible FAQ content meets current eligibility/requirements; never add invisible FAQ markup.
ItemList	Only for genuine ordered/list editorial pages.

Consistency rule

> **Visible text = metadata = schema = source data**
> Names, dates, quantities, places, author and status must agree across the page. Do not leave stale values in structured data after the article is updated.

Simple, typed and repository-first

Recommended stack

Area	v1 direction
Framework	Next.js App Router, current stable version at implementation time.
Language	TypeScript strict mode.
Styling	Tailwind utilities and CSS custom properties are acceptable implementation tools; visual result must follow the editorial design system.
Content	Repository-based Markdown/MDX + structured front matter or equivalent typed content files.
Validation	Zod or equivalent schema validation at build / test time.
Hosting	Vercel.
Version control	GitHub.
Search	Build-generated static index; no external AI dependency for MVP.
Analytics	Consent-controlled GA4; GSC; Bing Webmaster Tools considered.
CMS	Not required initially. Add only if repository workflow becomes a real editorial bottleneck.

Suggested repository domains

- content/ - articles or MDX files.
- data/sources - source registry.
- data/topics - stable topic IDs and knowledge-graph relationships.
- lib/content - loaders, validation, sorting and status rules.
- lib/search - generated search index and normalization.
- components/editorial - reusable article primitives.
- app/... - hubs, articles, policy pages and search.
- scripts - content audit, source freshness checks and link validation.

Build-time editorial validation

- Published article missing title, description, author, category or required dates → fail build/test.
- F2/F3 published article without source IDs or fact-check date → fail editorial validation.
- Unknown related-topic ID or broken internal route → fail link/relationship test.
- Duplicate slug or canonical → fail build/test.

- Image missing alt/credit fields according to its asset type → QA warning or failure depending on policy.

Trust is not only an editorial feature

Privacy and analytics

- No Google Analytics or third-party marketing call before the required user consent.
- Cookie / consent interface must be usable by keyboard and must not employ manipulative design.
- Free-text search analytics are potentially sensitive; apply consent, truncation and PII/safety filtering before logging queries.
- No advertising scripts at launch.
- Privacy policy must describe analytics, search logging and affiliate tracking actually in use - not hypothetical tools.

Accessibility

- Semantic landmarks and heading hierarchy.
- Visible keyboard focus; skip link; complete keyboard navigation.
- WCAG AA contrast target for text and controls.
- Labels for search and forms; icons never carry the only meaning.
- Readable body size and line length on mobile and desktop.
- Alt text and captions/credits handled according to image function.
- Tables must remain understandable on small screens; use stacked alternatives when needed.

Performance

Area	Requirement
LCP	Prioritize hero/LCP image and critical text; avoid JS-gated first content.
CLS	Reserve media dimensions and avoid late-injected UI; target near-zero layout shift.
JavaScript	Server Components by default; client code only for real interaction.
Fonts	Use efficient next/font or system fallback strategy; avoid excessive weights.
Images	Responsive optimized images, correct sizes, local/controlled sources.
Caching	Static/ISR where suitable; do not make evergreen articles depend on fragile live APIs.

Commercial intent should fund the reference product, not distort it

Three commercial classes

Class	Examples	Commercial treatment
Knowledge	Oil Fund, NAV, welfare state, politics, history.	Normally none. Keep the answer neutral and clean.
Editorial inspiration	Cabins, outdoor life, places, seasonal ideas.	Occasional relevant commercial link may be appropriate, clearly disclosed.
Transactional travel	Hotels, tours, itineraries, transport, car rental.	Affiliate CTAs can be prominent when they directly help the user complete the task.

Commercial independence

> **Editorial rule**
> Andreas' explanations and opinions are not for sale. A commercial relationship must never change a factual explanation or be disguised as a personal recommendation.

Affiliate architecture

- Use a central /go/[slug] system only when affiliate destinations exist and the redirect improves maintainability.
- Keep partner status, destination, checked date and fallback centrally controlled.
- Use rel="sponsored nofollow" where appropriate at the outgoing link.
- Track affiliate clicks with partner and placement dimensions after consent requirements are satisfied.
- Affiliate redirect routes are noindex and excluded from sitemap.
- Do not show a commercial CTA if the destination has not been verified or the partnership is inactive.

Later revenue options

Relevant travel affiliate programs, selected transport/activity partners, downloadable guides, newsletter sponsorship and eventually carefully controlled premium display advertising may be evaluated later. None are launch blockers.

Measure whether the product is becoming useful and authoritative

Core events

Event	Purpose
site_search	Understand what visitors seek.
site_search_no_results	Find vocabulary gaps and genuine content opportunities.
related_topic_click	Measure whether knowledge-graph navigation works.
source_click	Measure source-verification engagement.
affiliate_click	Commercial attribution on eligible pages.
newsletter_signup	Only if newsletter is added.

Early success metrics

- Indexed quality pages, not raw article count.
- Google Search Console impressions and clicks per topic cluster.
- CTR interpreted against position and intent.
- Queries each page earns, including unexpected long-tail wording.
- Referring domains and citations to authority pages.
- Internal navigation / related-topic engagement.
- Search no-result rate and common missing concepts.
- Affiliate clicks and revenue only on commercial pages.
- Branded “Norway Unpacked” queries over time.

Decision rule

Use Search Console and first-party behavior to decide what to expand. Do not create new categories or large content batches merely because traffic is currently low.

24 high-quality v1 articles, built in waves

The target below is the v1 editorial content set. It is not permission for Claude to generate 24 articles in one sprint. The first wave should deliberately test several article types and source-risk classes, then the system should be audited before expansion.

How Norway Works

Article	Role / freshness	Starter source direction
Norway's Oil Fund, Explained	Flagship authority; F3	NBIM + Ministry of Finance
Why Is Norway So Rich?	Bridge between oil, institutions and economy; F1	SSB / government / NBIM
How Norway's Welfare State Works	Authority; F1/F2	Government / NAV / SSB
The Nordic Model Explained	Authority/linkable; F1	Government / research / SSB
Why Isn't Norway in the EU?	High-interest explainer; F2	Government / Storting / EEA sources
How Norwegian Politics Works	System explainer; F2	Storting / government
What Is NAV?	Practical system; F2	NAV
How Healthcare Works in Norway	High-trust practical; F2	Helsenorge / government
The Norwegian Education System	High-trust practical; F2	Government / education authorities

Culture & Norwegian Life

Article	Role / freshness	Starter source direction
What Is Dugnad?	Signature Andreas article; F0/F1	Reference/history + personal context
What Is Friluftsliv?	Signature + outdoors bridge; F0/F1	Official/reference + personal context
What Is Janteloven?	Culture explainer; F0	Reference/history + careful interpretation
Why Norwegians Love Cabins	Personal/culture; F1	Statistics/reference + Andreas
What Is a Norwegian Matpakke?	Personal/everyday; F0	Andreas + cultural sources
What Happens on 17 May?	Culture/history bridge; F1	Official/history + Andreas
Why Does Norway Have Vinmonopolet?	Distinct system/culture; F2	Vinmonopolet / health-policy sources
Alcohol Rules in Norway	Practical; F2	Official sources

History

Article	Role / freshness	Starter source direction
A Short History of Norway	Authority pillar; F0	Reference/research
The Viking Age in Norway	Traffic + history pillar; F0	Museums/research/reference
Norway in 1814	Constitution / 17 May bridge; F0	Storting / archives / reference
How Oil Changed Norway	Modern history / economy bridge; F0/F1	Oil-history primary/reference

Travel & Outdoors

Article	Role / freshness	Starter source direction
Best Time to Visit Norway	Commercial-intent entry; F2	Weather/climate + official travel data
Oslo for First-Time Visitors	Travel template pilot; F2	Local transport / attractions / official sources
The Right to Roam in Norway	High-fit practical/outdoors authority; F1/F2	Official outdoor/legal guidance

First fast-follow candidates

Brunost, pølse, Norwegian Easter, russ, supermarkets, Norwegian monarchy, what is a kommune, cost of living, Bergen, Lofoten, Tromsø/northern lights, Norway in WWII, Sami people, Norse mythology start page.

Build the system before scaling the library

Phase	Deliverable
Phase 0 - Preflight and repo	Create repository, CLAUDE.md, indexability gate, project docs, baseline lint/typecheck/build. No public indexing.
Phase 1 - Design shell	Implement header, footer, tokens, homepage skeleton and one hub. Validate mobile/desktop against approved visual direction.
Phase 2 - Content/source system	MDX/data schemas, source registry, freshness classes, article primitives, relationship model and build-time validation.
Phase 3 - Five pilot articles	Oil Fund (F3), Dugnad (personal), Short History (F0), Right to Roam (official practical), Oslo (travel/commercial shape).
Phase 4 - Search and knowledge graph	Static search index, aliases/synonyms, no-results UX, curated related-topic navigation.
Phase 5 - Editorial expansion	Expand in controlled batches to the 24-article v1 set; fact check each batch and audit templates.
Phase 6 - Trust / SEO / analytics	Policy pages, metadata/schema, consent-controlled analytics, GSC/Bing, sitemap/robots and link/source validation.
Phase 7 - Pre-launch release	Full QA, accessibility/performance check, indexability switch, production verification and baseline measurement.

Pilot acceptance before scaling

- All five pilot pages render cleanly on mobile and desktop.
- Source blocks and freshness rules are correct for F0-F3.
- Metadata and schema validate.
- Internal related-topic links are curated and not broken.
- Search can find pilots by English and selected Norwegian aliases.
- No content is indexed prematurely.
- Article design does not drift into generic card-heavy Tailwind styling.
- Build/lint/typecheck/tests are green.

One coordinated project team, one mode at a time

Claude should follow the supplied Swane Creative project-team standard. It must behave as a coordinated project team, not as many independent agents modifying code at once. Every sprint starts by establishing actual status and scope.

Modes

Mode	Allowed behavior
A. Audit	Read, test and report. No code changes.
B. Implementation	Perform only the approved bounded sprint. Test continuously.
C. Release	Run quality gate, review diff, commit/push only when explicitly requested, verify production.

Relevant roles for Norway Unpacked

- Project lead / solution architect.
- Product and UX lead.
- Design-system reviewer.
- Senior frontend engineer.
- Technical SEO / information architect.
- Content editor / fact checker.
- Data and domain validator for source registry and freshness.
- AI-search / answer optimizer.
- QA / browser tester.
- Performance / accessibility / security reviewer.
- CRO / affiliate / trust reviewer when commercial pages exist.
- Release manager.

Hard preservation requirements

1. English-only product unless Andreas explicitly changes scope.
2. Public byline is Andreas.
3. Never fabricate Andreas' personal experiences.
4. Never mark facts or sources as verified without actual verification.
5. Prefer primary sources for changing, legal, health, economic and official information.
6. Do not drift to generic Tailwind/SaaS styling.
7. No aggressive display advertising.

8. Do not place irrelevant commercial CTAs in knowledge content.
9. No programmatic mass publishing before template/source/indexing checks are proven.
10. Search/AI may not invent answers when verified content is missing.
11. Sources & Fact Check is a product requirement.
12. Mobile quality is equal priority to desktop.
13. No release without documented QA.

Sprint reporting

Each Claude delivery should report: summary, scope/roles, prioritized decisions/findings, implemented changes, verification evidence, preservation checks, residual issues and git/deploy status.

24 / PRE-LAUNCH QUALITY GATE

Nothing is “done” because the build is green

Area	Release check
Content	Direct answers, language, source status, dates, no invented personal claims, no placeholders.
Source quality	Official links open; claims supported; F2/F3 review dates current.
SEO	Unique title/description/H1; canonical; sitemap; robots; indexability gate; internal links.
Schema	Article/WebPage/Breadcrumb and author fields match visible content.
Mobile	320 px through common mobile widths; menu/search; no overflow; readable source links.
Desktop	Representative wide viewports; reading width and media layout remain editorial.
Accessibility	Keyboard, focus, labels, headings, landmarks, contrast and alt text.
Performance	LCP/CLS, image sizing, JS budget, font loading and caching.
Privacy	Consent works; no forbidden pre-consent third-party calls; policy matches actual tools.
Commercial	Affiliate links, disclosure, sponsored/nofollow and /go behavior only if enabled.
Engineering	Lint, typecheck, build, tests, console/hydration/network errors.
Production	Apex/www behavior, HTTPS, GSC ownership, analytics, 404, live routes, source links.

Indexing release gate
SITE_INDEXABLE (or equivalent) remains off until the release manager has documented that the launch content, metadata, sources, legal pages and production behavior are ready.

APPENDIX A

Content opportunity map - beyond the 24-article v1 set

Relative opportunity is based on the supplied Ubersuggest competitor data, project fit and discovery work. It is not an exact monthly search-volume forecast.

World	Topic	Demand	Fit	Freshness	Timing
How Norway Works	What Is the Storting?	M	5/5	F2	Phase 2
How Norway Works	What Is a Kommune?	M	5/5	F2	Phase 2
How Norway Works	Norwegian Monarchy Explained	H	5/5	F2	Phase 2
How Norway Works	Taxes in Norway Explained	H	5/5	F3	Phase 2
How Norway Works	Norwegian Continental Shelf	H	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Life	Supermarkets in Norway	VH	4/5	F2	Phase 2
Life	Cost of Living in Norway	VH	4/5	F3	Phase 2
Life	Norwegian Social Etiquette	H	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Life	Why Norwegians Take Shoes Off Indoors	M	5/5	F0	Phase 2
Life	Friday Taco in Norway	M	5/5	F0	Phase 2
Life	Public Holidays in Norway	H seasonal	4/5	F2	Phase 2
Life	Barnehage Explained	M/H	5/5	F2	Phase 2
Life	BankID Explained	M/H	5/5	F2	Phase 2
Culture	Norwegian Easter	H seasonal	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Culture	What Is Russ?	M/H	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Culture	Koselig Explained	M	5/5	F0	Phase 2
Culture	Norwegian Christmas Traditions	H seasonal	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Culture	Bunad Explained	H	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Culture	Norwegian Swear Words	H	4/5	F0	Later
History	Norse Mythology: Start Here	VH	4/5	F0	Phase 2
History	Norway in World War II	H	5/5	F0	Phase 2
History	The Sami People of Norway	H	5/5	F1	Phase 2
History	Norwegian Independence in 1905	M	5/5	F0	Phase 2
History	Norwegian Black Metal	H niche	4/5	F0	Later
History	Norse Gods and Goddesses	VH	3/5	F0	Later

History	Leif Erikson	H	4/5	F0	Later
Travel	7 Days in Norway	VH	4/5	F2	Phase 2
Travel	Bergen Guide	H	4/5	F2	Phase 2
Travel	Lofoten Guide	VH	4/5	F2	Phase 2
Travel	Tromsø & Northern Lights	VH	4/5	F2	Phase 2
Travel	Best Fjord Tours from Bergen	H	4/5	F3	Phase 2
Travel	Oslo-Copenhagen Ferry	H	4/5	F3	Phase 2
Travel	Is Norway Expensive to Visit?	H	5/5	F2	Phase 2
Travel	Norway Road Trip Basics	H	4/5	F2	Later
Nature	Northern Lights Explained	VH	5/5	F1/F2	Phase 2
Nature	Midnight Sun Explained	H	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Nature	Fjords Explained	H	5/5	F0	Phase 2
Nature	Dangerous Animals in Norway	M/H	4/5	F1	Later
Nature	Norwegian Weather Explained	H	5/5	F2	Phase 2
Food	Brunost Explained	H	5/5	F0	Fast follow
Food	Norwegian Pølse	H	5/5	F0	Fast follow
Food	Norwegian Waffles	H	5/5	F0	Phase 2
Food	Fårikål	M/H	5/5	F0	Phase 2
Food	Pinnekjøtt	M/H	5/5	F0	Phase 2
Food	Aquavit	M/H	4/5	F1	Later
Sport	Why Norway Loves Cross-Country Skiing	M/H	5/5	F1	Phase 2
Sport	Norwegian Handball	M	4/5	F2	Later
Sport	Biathlon in Norway	M	4/5	F2	Later
Sport	Norwegian Football Explained	H	4/5	F2	Phase 2
Sport	Kubb in Norway	H	4/5	F0	Phase 2

APPENDIX B

Starter source registry by editorial area

This is a responsibility map, not a frozen list of URLs. During article production Claude must open and verify the current official page rather than guess a deep link.

Area	Primary / high-trust source direction
Oil Fund / economy	Norges Bank Investment Management; Ministry of Finance; Statistics Norway; relevant petroleum authorities.
Politics / government	Stortinget; Government of Norway; election authorities for election procedures.
NAV / welfare	NAV; relevant ministries; Statistics Norway for contextual statistics.
Healthcare	Helsenorge; Ministry / Directorate of Health; relevant public health bodies.
Education	Government / education authorities; universities only for institution-specific claims.
Taxes	Norwegian Tax Administration; Ministry of Finance.
Alcohol / Vinmonopolet	Vinmonopolet; health authorities; legislation / official guidance where required.
History / 1814	Stortinget / archives / museums / SNL / peer-reviewed research as appropriate.
Vikings / Norse	Museums, universities, primary archaeological/research institutions, reputable reference works.
Nature / right to roam	Environment/outdoor authorities, protected-area authorities, official legal guidance.
Travel / transport	Official local transport operators, airports, destination organisations and direct operator pages for current schedules/prices.
Statistics	Statistics Norway first for national demographic/economic statistics when available.

Correction workflow

1. User or editor reports a possible error.
2. Open the currently cited source and at least one primary source if the claim is material.
3. Correct the article and structured fields together.
4. Update factCheckedAt/dateModified as appropriate.
5. Record material correction in editorial notes if it affected user decisions or a high-risk claim.

APPENDIX C

Example route map and internal-link model

World	Hub	Example child routes
How Norway Works	/how-norway-works	/oil-fund, /why-norway-is-rich, /welfare-state, /why-norway-isnt-in-the-eu, /nav, /healthcare, /education.
Culture	/culture	/dugnad, /friluftsliv, /janteloven, /17-may, /vinmonopolet, /matpakke.
History	/history	/history-of-norway, /viking-age, /1814, /oil-changed-norway.
Travel	/travel	/best-time-to-visit, /oslo-first-time-visitors.
Nature	/nature	/right-to-roam.

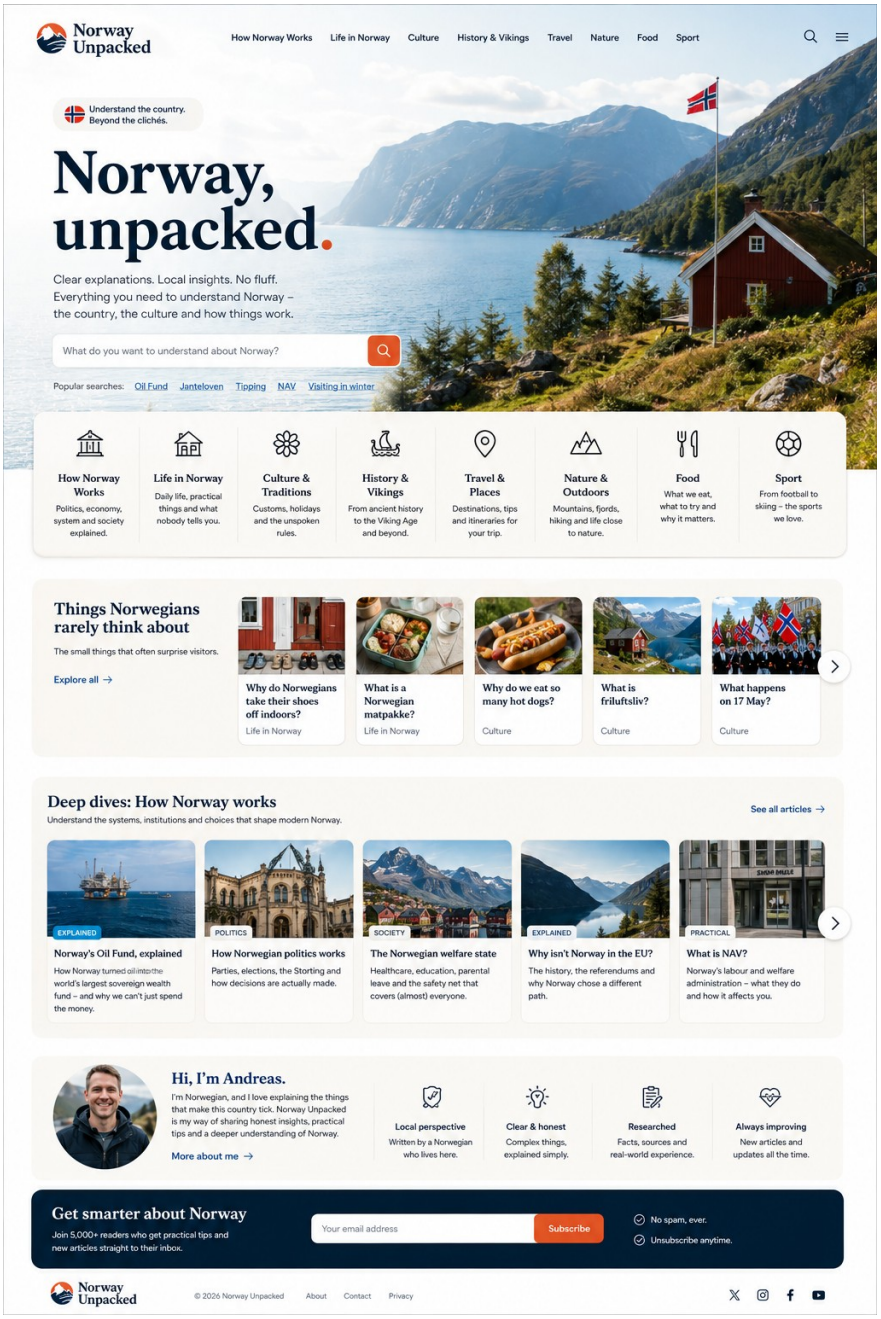
Slug note

The examples above show meaning, not a final slug freeze. Before implementation, confirm the exact route naming convention once and keep it stable. Avoid date-based WordPress-style URLs.

APPENDIX D

Approved visual direction reference

The image below captures the approved direction: an editorial hero, calm navigation, prominent search, structured topic discovery, a personal Andreas module and a stronger “How Norway works” section. It is a visual reference, not a pixel-perfect production specification.



Design QA should compare the implemented homepage against the principles in Section 13 rather than simply checking whether individual components resemble this mockup.

APPENDIX E

Research inputs and governing standards

Swane Creative project standards used

- Claude-prosjektteam - roller, arbeidsflyt og kvalitetssikring, version 1.0 (July 2026).
- Standard for metadata, SEO og AI-sok, version 1.0 (July 2026).
- Felles PRD-sjekkliste for nye nettsteder - Swane Creative project template.
- Master prompt - AI partner for affiliate & AI sites (used for business / monetization framing where relevant).
- Setup Guide 2026 was reviewed, but animation / component-library recommendations are not requirements; Norway Unpacked has a bespoke editorial design direction.

Competitor / search research used

- Ubersuggest exports and traffic overview files for lifeinnorway.net in US and UK.
- Ubersuggest export and traffic overview for norwaywithpal.com in US.
- Ubersuggest export and traffic overview for norwayexplained.com in US.
- Earlier directional research of thenorwayguide.com and direct visual review of NorwayExplained, The Norway Guide and Norway With Pal.
- Representative source / intent research carried out before finalizing the content opportunity map.

v1.1 pre-build decisions

- Preliminary public name / trademark checks found no obvious Norway Unpacked conflict; this is not formal legal clearance.
- No prior public domain history was found in the checks performed before build planning.
- Public contact locked to kontakt@swanecreative.no.
- Placeholder-first asset workflow added as a hard build requirement.

Interpretation warning

Ubersuggest numbers are estimates and are not first-party analytics from competitor sites. Use them to identify patterns and relative opportunity, not to forecast Norway Unpacked traffic as guaranteed volumes.

END OF CORE PRD v1.1

Appendix F on the following pages is part of v1.1 and defines the image-placeholder catalog and asset metadata required before image procurement. Next action after Andreas approval: create the Claude project/repository instructions and run Phase 0 preflight. Do not start mass article generation.

APPENDIX F

Homepage image placeholder catalog

These IDs are layout contracts, not asset approvals. Build the final dimensions and crop behavior now; replace a placeholder only after the asset is explicitly approved.

ID	Required visual brief
HOME-HERO-01	Wide editorial Norway scene with space for hero text. Recognizably Norwegian, but not pure postcard tourism. Fjord / mountain can appear with signs of real life such as a house, road, ferry or settlement. Safe desktop and mobile crops.
HOME-CULTURE-01	Shoes by the entrance of a normal Norwegian home. Everyday and believable, not luxury interior stock.
HOME-CULTURE-02	A typical Norwegian matpakke. Simple packed lunch, believable everyday presentation, not restaurant styling.
HOME-CULTURE-03	Norwegian polse in a Norwegian context - kiosk, outing or 17 May - not a generic American hot dog image.
HOME-CULTURE-04	Cabin / friluftsliv scene that feels used and real. Avoid luxury-property advertising aesthetics.
HOME-CULTURE-05	Authentic 17 May scene: flags, parade or people. Must be clearly Norwegian and culturally credible.
HOME-WORKS-01	North Sea offshore / energy visual for oil and Oil Fund context. Avoid generic oil-barrel graphics or misleading fund imagery.
HOME-WORKS-02	Stortinget or another concrete democratic / political Norway visual. Documentary, factual context.
HOME-WORKS-03	Everyday Norwegian public-service / social infrastructure scene that can represent welfare state without cheesy stock metaphors.
HOME-WORKS-04	Norway / Europe visual for EEA / EU context. Must not imply Norway is an EU member.
HOME-WORKS-05	NAV office, sign or credible public-service context. Prefer documentary visual over generic office people.
ABOUT-ANDREAS-01	Real portrait of Andreas. Natural, informal, credible. Never AI-generated.

APPENDIX F / CONTINUED

Article image briefs and asset schema

Reusable article placeholder classes

- **ARTICLE-HERO-[slug]** - Every major article can declare a hero brief with subject, mood, crop / orientation, factual risks, what to avoid and alt-text intent.
- **TRAVEL-[slug]** - Place-specific photography. The asset must genuinely show the named place or clearly state when it is contextual rather than documentary.
- **HISTORY-[slug]** - Historical photograph, artwork, object, archive material or present-day location with documented source / rights. AI reconstructions must never masquerade as historical evidence.
- **FOOD-[slug]** - Authentic Norwegian food or product in a credible setting. Avoid generic food stock that changes the dish or context.
- **NATURE-[slug]** - Location / species / outdoor scene must be geographically and factually appropriate when the article makes a specific claim.
- **SOCIETY-[slug]** - Documentary Norwegian daily-life context for institutions and systems; avoid generic corporate stock where a real Norwegian setting is available.

Minimum asset metadata

```
image: {
status: "placeholder" | "approved",
src?: string,
brief: string,
alt: string,
aspectRatio: string,
focalPoint?: string,
source?: string,
credit?: string,
license?: string
}
```

Placeholder rendering rule

- Placeholder UI must use the intended final aspect ratio and responsive behavior. It may show a quiet neutral block with the placeholder ID and brief in development / preview environments.
- Production must never expose unfinished placeholder copy as if it were editorial content. An article with a required but unapproved hero asset either uses an approved fallback policy or remains unpublished according to the content status rules.
- No asset is considered approved solely because Claude found it, generated it or inserted a remote URL. Asset approval is an explicit editorial decision.

> **Asset acceptance gate**
>
> Before an image changes from placeholder to approved, confirm: correct subject / place, rights or ownership, required credit, useful alt text, crop at target breakpoints, file optimization, and no misleading documentary implication.